Lot Evaluation Checklist

Print this and take it to a showing. A parcel being for sale does not make it buildable.

Access and legal

[ ] Legal, recorded access to a public road (not a handshake easement)
[ ] Easements on the title that cross the buildable area
[ ] Zoning permits a single-family dwelling of the size you want
[ ] Setbacks, height limit, and lot coverage leave a real building envelope
[ ] CCRs or HOA design review requirements obtained in writing
[ ] Any plat notes or conditions of approval reviewed

Utilities

[ ] Power: at the property line, or how far away and who pays to extend
[ ] Water: municipal at the line, or a well is required
[ ] Sewer: municipal at the line, or a septic system is required
[ ] Septic feasibility: CDH in Ada County; SWDH in Canyon County
[ ] Natural gas available, or plan for propane or all-electric
[ ] Internet and phone service available at the address

Ground conditions

[ ] Slope across the building envelope, and what it does to excavation
[ ] Soils: whether a geotechnical report is required
[ ] Groundwater depth and seasonal high water table
[ ] Fill on site from prior grading or farming
[ ] Rock, caliche, or hardpan that changes excavation cost
[ ] Drainage: where water goes in a spring melt

Regulatory and environmental

[ ] FEMA floodplain designation checked
[ ] Irrigation district ditches, laterals, or delivery obligations
[ ] Wildland-urban interface requirements if foothills
[ ] Wetlands or protected features
[ ] Any recorded agricultural or water rights that transfer

Cost to build here

Item	Estimated $	Confirmed by
Land purchase	_____	
Well	_____	Driller quote
Septic system	_____	Designer / health district
Driveway and access	_____	
Power extension	_____	Utility
Excavation and grading	_____	Builder
Impact and connection fees	_____	Jurisdiction

Before you make an offer

- Make the offer contingent on septic feasibility and a soils review
- Give yourself enough inspection period to get real quotes, not guesses
- A written lot evaluation runs $950 to $5,500 and is credited toward design if you build with us
- Lot evaluation: https://boiseconstruction.co/services/lot-evaluation
- Land guide: https://boiseconstruction.co/guides/buying-land-to-build-boise